

17 May 2026 17:00:18 ET | 15 pages

Greater China Semiconductors

May Week 3 Recap: H200 Approval Unlikely to Derail China Localization, WFE Upside on Memory Expansion

CITI'S TAKE

We review Week 3 (May 11–15) for the China/Hong Kong semiconductor sector. Positive AI sentiment supported a rally in SiC, memory, and equipment, while domestic GPU and CPU were dampened by a potential Nvidia H200 approval. We believe the 750k H200 import allowance cannot meet China's aggressive AI capacity build and would not alter the AI localization progress. Domestic WFE demand is seeing upside on China's accelerating memory capacity expansion. We prefer **ASMPT** and **SG Micro** on improving industry outlook and better risk/reward in our view.

May week 3 share price movement — CN/HK semis rallied on positive AI sentiment, with SiC (TSEM results, price stabilization), memory (supply tightness, YMTC filing for IPO), and semis equipment (demand upside) gaining the most. GPU and CPU pulled back on concerns of a potential H200 import approval.

H200 approval unlikely to change localization outlook — The US has reportedly cleared sales of Nvidia H200 chips to 10 Chinese firms ([Reuters, 14 May](#)) for up to 75k chips per company. We believe the combined 750k volume is in line with industry expectations. While near-term negative to local AI accelerators, foundries, and WFE vendors, 750k is far below China's AI chip demand, which could still be met by sourcing from domestic accelerators. We view an H200 approval mildly positive for server vendors and Montage (upside for memory interface, PCIe retimers).

WFE demand upside on memory capacity expansion — CN WFE vendors AMEC and NAURA are seeing demand upside given strong memory capacity expansion. YMTC is reportedly submitting an IPO filing in June. We expect CXMT IPO in 2H26 and YMTC in 2027, and both memory makers to accelerate their capacity expansion in 2H26–2027.

Strong CN CSP capex — Alibaba reported expanded C1Q26 capex with AI capex upside (vs. original Rmb380bn) in the next 3–5 years. Tencent capex grew 16% YoY to Rmb31.9bn in 1Q26 while guiding for capex increase in 2H26. ByteDance is raising its 2026 capex by 25% to Rmb200bn. We expect the rising CN CSP capex to further propel demand for the domestic supply chain.

Top picks: ASMPT, SG Micro — We prefer **ASMPT** (back-end equipment) given: 1) TCB/AP demand upside; 2) rising OSAT capex; and 3) back-end refocusing. We see broadening opportunities in TCB and photonics, and expect share re-rating beyond historical range. **SG Micro** (analog) should benefit from price upside as TXN and NXPI plan another round of price hikes. SG Micro is seeking additional foundry capacity to meet incremental demand. Supply-demand is improving as AI applications claim a larger share of industry capacity. We continue to view **Montage** as best positioned among CN semis to invest in AI capacity expansion. Kioxia's strong outlook should carry positive sentiment for memory in the near term. That said, we see less attractive risk/reward after the recent share rally.

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

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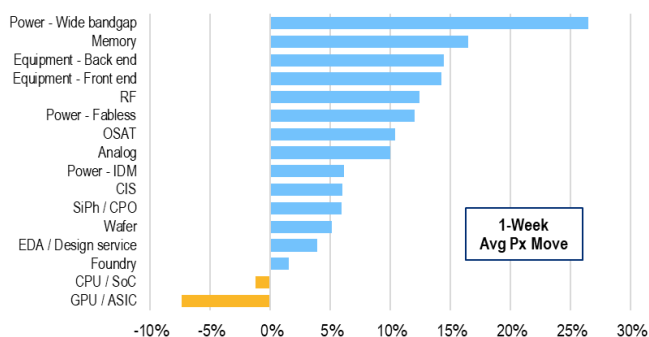
Figure 1. Share Price Movement by Sector

15-May-2026	1W	1M	3M	6M	12M
Foundry	1.5%	22.6%	6.8%	21.0%	130.7%
OSAT	10.4%	12.9%	10.8%	37.9%	73.9%
Equipment - Front end	14.2%	29.2%	23.6%	49.7%	121.8%
Equipment - Back end	14.4%	38.9%	49.1%	147.6%	293.1%
CPU / SoC	-1.2%	22.7%	12.6%	37.6%	67.2%
GPU / ASIC	-7.4%	19.3%	34.6%	6.0%	27.7%
Memory	16.5%	42.3%	59.5%	74.5%	279.7%
SiPh / CPO	6.0%	28.9%	80.4%	186.9%	691.2%
Analog	10.0%	35.5%	37.1%	52.4%	73.3%
Power - IDM	6.2%	17.5%	0.7%	35.8%	61.5%
Power - Fabless	12.0%	20.9%	1.1%	31.3%	79.9%
Power - Wide bandgap	26.5%	48.6%	33.1%	42.3%	51.9%
CIS	6.0%	12.6%	-4.8%	-1.9%	-0.6%
RF	12.4%	15.0%	24.6%	30.9%	36.0%
EDA / Design service	3.9%	14.2%	-3.4%	24.3%	92.9%
Wafer	5.1%	34.4%	22.6%	25.2%	48.2%

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Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

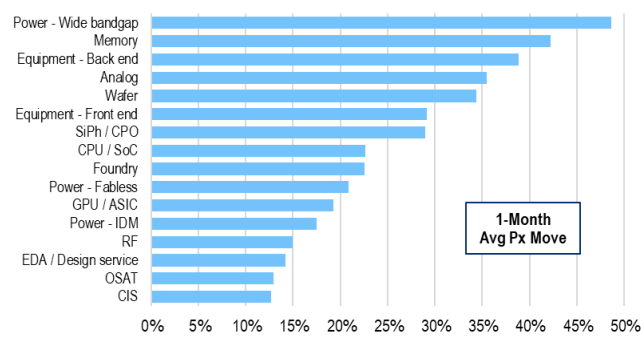
Figure 2. Share Price Movement – 1 Week



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Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

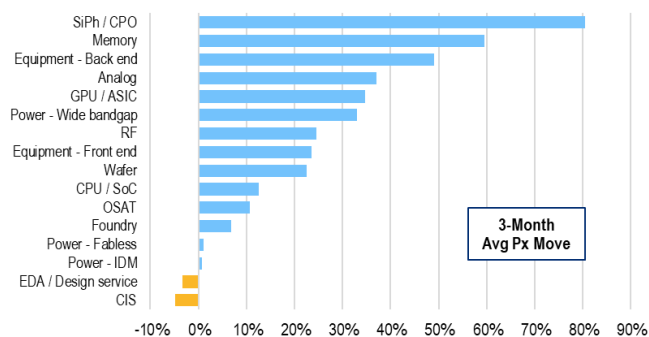
Figure 3. Share Price Movement – 1 Month



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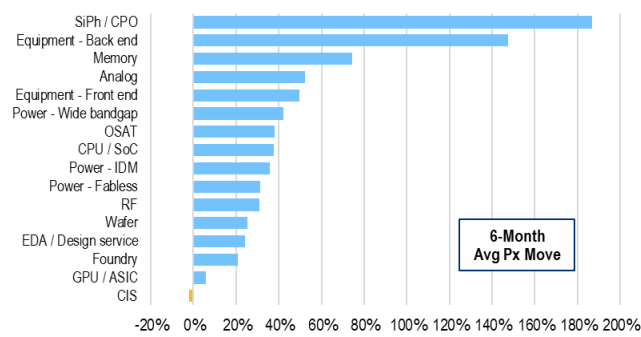
Figure 4. Share Price Movement – 3 Months



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Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 5. Share Price Movement – 6 Months



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Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Recent published notes:

- [Greater China Semiconductors – Quick Thoughts on Potential H200 China Sales Clearance](#)
- [China Datacenters – Quick Thoughts on Chinese CSP Capex Up in 1Q26 & H200 China Sales Clearance](#)
- [China Technology – Read-across from US CSP Capex and Optics Peer Commentaries](#)

- [OmniVision \(603501.SS\) – What’s New from Citi 2026 China Elite Corporate Day – Recovery Expected From 2Q26](#)
- [SG Micro \(300661.SZ\) – Model Update; Brighter Outlook on Positive Pricing Trend](#)
- [ASMPT \(0522.HK\) – Broadening TCB/Photonics Opportunities; Lift TP to HK\\$180](#)

ASMPT

(0522.HK; HK\$172.0; 1; 15 May 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our target price of HK\$180 is based on peak valuation of 37x 2027E P/E. We view the peak valuation as justified because we expect strong revenue and earnings recovery driven by: 1) AI-driven advanced packaging order wins, including TCB for HBM and CoW applications; and 2) ongoing recovery of mainstream SEMI and SMT. Potential sales of SMT business could solidify its market position as a leading provider of advanced packaging solutions, leading to valuation re-rating beyond its historical range.

Risks

Downside risks to our target price being achieved include: 1) a slowdown in AI infrastructure outlook with delayed investment; 2) TCB market share loss at key customers; 3) reduced TCB demand due to alternative technologies, such as hybrid bonding; 4) intensifying industry competition; and 5) export restriction extending to back-end equipment.

Montage Technology

(6809.HK; HK\$448.6; 1; 15 May 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our target price for Montage-H is set at HK\$305 based on 66x 2027E P/E, at 10% premium to our Montage-A share target multiple. We view Montage-H a rare opportunity for international investors to invest in both China and global AI data center expansion. Such quality name with strong AI-thematic has gained strong traction from international investors and resulted in an unusual H-share premium over its A-share counterpart.

We believe the valuation is justified given Montage's improving product mix (DDR5 Gen 3 surpassing Gen 2) and growing contribution from new AI-driven connectivity solutions (MRDIMM, CXL), with demand upside coming from agentic AI and inferencing. The company should continue to benefit from China's increasing semiconductor localization in the coming few years.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price include: 1) AI infrastructure capex slowdown, 2) market share loss if international customers shift away from Chinese suppliers; 3) rising SOCAMM / LPDDR adoption in servers that reduces memory interface demand, 4) delayed product migration (DDR5 sub-gen) and development (PCIe switch, CXL switch).

Citi's quant system rates Montage-H high-risk given its short trading history. We view Montage's fundamentals remain strong and expect solid AI-driven revenue/earnings momentum in the coming years. As such, we do not assign a High-Risk rating to Montage-H.

Montage Technology

(688008.SS; Rmb247.98; 1; 15 May 26; 15:00)

Valuation

Our target price of Rmb245 is based on 60x 2027E P/E, at 1.5SD above its 5-year average. We believe the valuation is justified given Montage's improving product mix (DDR5 Gen 3 surpassing Gen 2) and growing contribution from new AI-driven connectivity solutions (MRDIMM, CXL), with demand upside coming from agentic AI and inferencing. The company should continue to benefit from China's increasing semiconductor localization in the coming few years.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price include: 1) AI infrastructure capex slowdown, 2) market share loss if international customers shift away from Chinese suppliers; 3) rising SOCAMM / LPDDR adoption in servers that reduces memory interface demand, 4) delayed product migration (DDR5 sub-gen) and development (PCIe switch, CXL switch).

SG Micro

(300661.SZ; Rmb107.9; 1; 15 May 26; 15:00)

Valuation

Our target price of Rmb120 is based on 61x 2027E P/E, set at its 5-year average valuation. Chinese analog stocks have traded at higher valuation vs. international peers driven by expectation of increasing analog localization. We expect steady market share gain for SG Micro to drive strong top- and bottom-line growth in the coming years.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price include: 1) intensifying price competition from global and Chinese peers; 2) GPM compression as SG Micro overly prioritize market share over profitability; 3) tariff-induced industry inventory overbuilt leading to correction; 4) inventory write-off.

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Appendix A-1

ANALYST CERTIFICATION

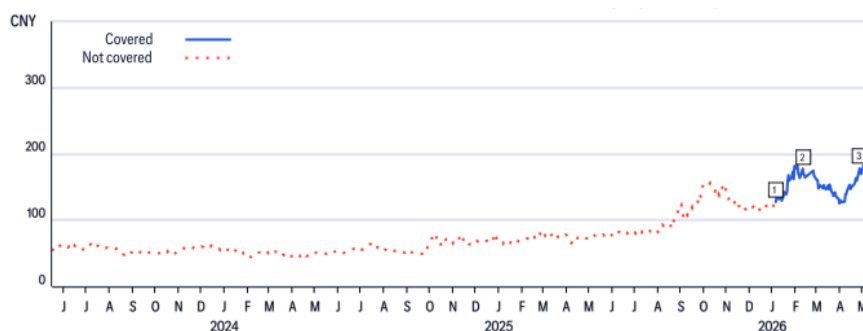
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Montage Technology (688008.SS)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	05-Jan-26 16:00:18	*1	*170.00	127.75

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
2	10-Feb-26 04:59:21	1	*205.00	177.50

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
3	27-Apr-26 18:12:40	1	*245.00	178.09

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

SG Micro (300661.SZ)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	16-Aug-23 18:16:35	2	*61.54	60.01
2	26-May-24 20:50:54	2	*57.69	56.82

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
3	29-Aug-24 18:57:29	*1	*64.62	51.79
4	07-Apr-25 18:56:35	1	*88.46	70.00

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5	02-Sep-25 13:15:51	1	*100.00	74.30
6	07-May-26 12:41:11	1	*120.00	89.95

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

ASMPT (0522.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	28-May-23 23:18:47	2	*63.00	62.89
2	26-Jul-23 21:43:15	2	*85.00	78.46
3	25-Oct-23 19:24:43	*1	85.00	67.92
4	28-Feb-24 17:15:12	1	*120.00	90.64
5	24-Apr-24 15:46:35	1	*140.00	100.84

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
6	24-Jul-24 08:56:09	1	*110.00	87.21
7	31-Oct-24 04:34:18	1	*105.00	84.08
8	26-Feb-25 12:15:35	1	*75.00	63.47
9	01-May-25 13:33:57	1	*65.00	51.73
10	23-Jul-25 13:13:41	1	*75.00	62.91

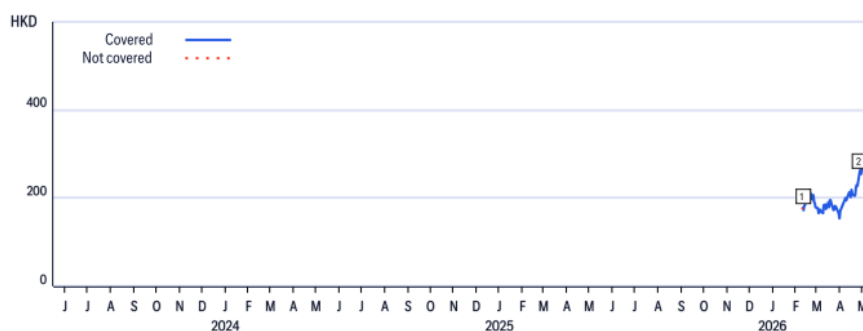
	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
11	11-Aug-25 11:00:54	1	*85.00	69.88
12	31-Oct-25 03:41:57	1	*100.00	81.63
13	21-Jan-26 18:19:50	1	*125.00	101.34
14	04-Mar-26 15:09:09	1	*145.00	107.51
15	22-Apr-26 15:53:46	1	*180.00	151.51

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Montage Technology (6809.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	10-Feb-26 04:59:21	*1	*205.00	178.00

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
2	27-Apr-26 18:12:40	1	*305.00	259.20

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

ASMPT (0522.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	24-Jul-24 04:56:09	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	87.21
2	23-Aug-24 14:19:04	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	86.26

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
3	23-Jul-25 09:13:41	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	62.91
4	22-Oct-25 00:34:21	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	83.17

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
5	14-Apr-26 00:41:45	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	124.93
6	15-May-26 00:28:53	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	172.00

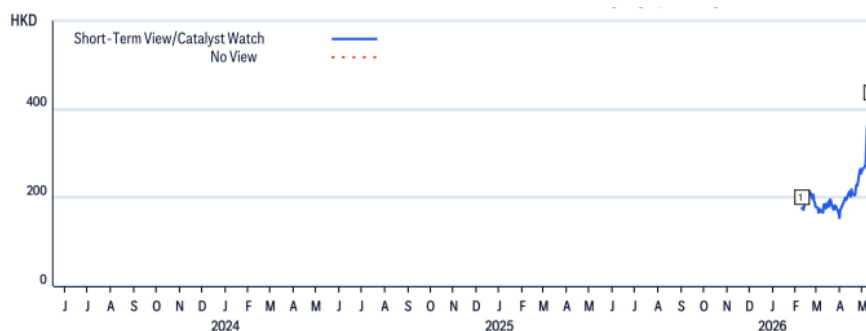
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Montage Technology (6809.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	09-Feb-26 23:59:21	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	175.00

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
2	12-May-26 00:13:10	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	413.00

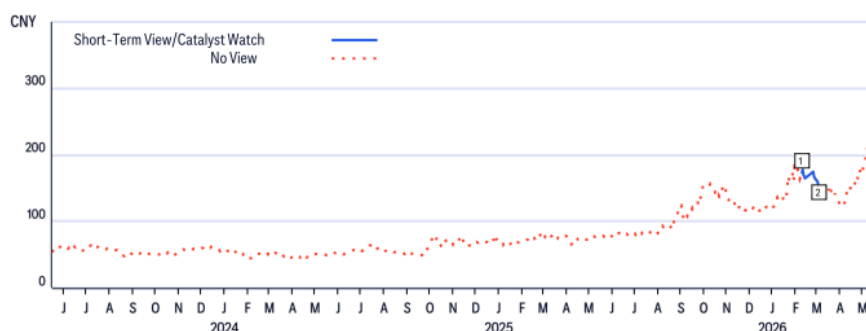
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Montage Technology (688008.SS)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	09-Feb-26 23:59:21	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	173.45

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
2	04-Mar-26 01:14:39	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	150.31

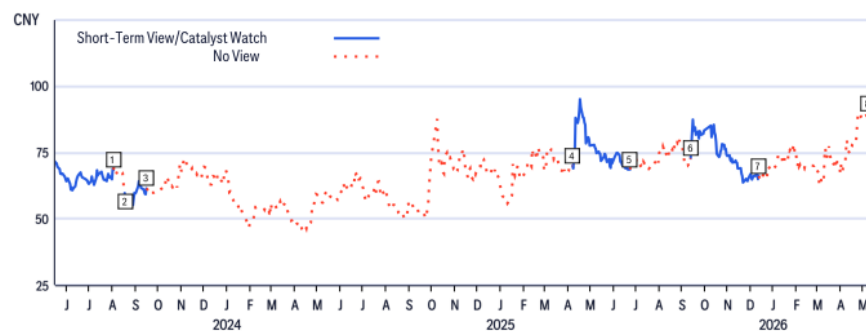
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

SG Micro (300661.SZ)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	02-Aug-23 13:09:57	Remove CW	Downside	90 Days	68.42
2	17-Aug-23 04:17:51	Add CW	Downside	30 Days	59.70
3	16-Sep-23 13:12:49	Remove CW	Downside	30 Days	61.45

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
4	07-Apr-25 14:56:35	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	70.00
5	23-Jun-25 03:10:05	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	68.63
6	14-Sep-25 13:42:50	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	72.85

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
7	12-Dec-25 12:07:16	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	66.16
8	07-May-26 08:41:11	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	89.95

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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